



# The Year in Cross-Border Payments: 2025



2025 Changed Cross-Border Payments  
Stablecoins. ISO 20022. Wallets. Wire automation.  
What community banks need to know heading  
into 2026.





# The Big Picture

Global payments are still growing, but  
the rails are changing.

Global payments remain one of the  
most valuable sectors in finance, even as  
growth slows and competition increases.

👉 The question is no longer if  
international payments matter, but how  
community banks and CUs participate.



# SWIFT Modernized

SWIFT is no longer just messaging.

Real-time tracking, blockchain interoperability, shared ledgers, and AI-powered fraud tools are reshaping correspondent banking expectations.



# Stablecoins Picked Up Steam

Stablecoins entered regulated finance.

With the GENIUS Act and major pilots from Visa, Stripe, PayPal, and Zelle, tokenized settlement is no longer fringe — it's part of the roadmap.





# Wallets Took the Lead Globally

**Wallets and A2A payments surged worldwide.**

From Asia-Pacific to Europe and Africa, real-time and wallet-based payments became the default for many consumers and businesses.



# Regional Momentum

Every region moved, differently.

Europe mandated instant payments.

Asia led with wallets and CBDCs.

Latin America expanded real-time rails.

Africa invested in payment  
infrastructure.

The Middle East advanced digital  
remittances.





# Wire Automation Became Essential

Manual wires don't scale anymore.

ISO 20022, compliance demands, and customer expectations pushed banks toward automation, not as a nice-to-have, but as core infrastructure.



# What This Means for Community Banks

Four priorities for 2026:

- Capture FX and non-interest income
  - Automate international wires
- Diversify correspondent relationships
- Learn about and stay ahead of digital assets





# Evolve Your Cross-border Payments Strategy.

Community banks that modernize, automate, and stay informed will be best positioned to compete.

Read the full year-in-review to see what's next.

👉 [acceleronbank.com/articles](https://acceleronbank.com/articles)

